Front card: What to notice and say

Preference signals: more detail, faster pace, warmer tone, specific examples, return questions, callbacks, body orientation, longer digital replies.
Soft check: "I noticed more [signal] around [topic]. Is that worth staying with, or should we move on?"
Do not claim: "You obviously want to talk about X."

Minimum move

More energy on [topic]? Stay there or move on?

TC056 two-card combined view

Back card: Calibrate and recover

Green cues: longer answers, more examples, easier tone, correction that still stays with the topic, questions back.
Amber cues: polite but short answers, mixed warmth, deflecting humour, delayed digital reply.
Red cues: stated boundary, discomfort, defensive correction, repeated short answers, shutdown silence.
Recovery: "I may have overread that. Let us leave it."

Choice is the safety mechanism.